MUHAMMAD RAFIQ

SENIOR MANAGER IT INFRASTRUCTURE & OPERATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT infrastructure and operations leader with 20+ years of experience across enterprise technology, managed services, and 24/7 broadcast environments in Pakistan and Qatar. Combines hands-on delivery of virtualization, identity services, network security, backup, and disaster recovery with team leadership and vendor management. Currently Senior Manager IT at News14, overseeing IT and broadcast technology operations for three television channels. Previous delivery includes infrastructure supporting 1,500+ users, Veeam protection for 120 virtual and physical servers, and approximately 30% faster disaster recovery.

CORE EXPERTISE

Infrastructure Leadership | IT Operations | High Availability | Virtualization | Cloud Administration | Active Directory | Network Segmentation | Firewall Deployment | Backup & Disaster Recovery | IT Service Management | Vendor & SLA Management | Team Development | Broadcast Technology

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager IT | News14

September, 2026 - Present | Pakistan

- Lead IT and broadcast IT operations across three channel services: News14 and Dharti TV (regional), and City 21 (international).
- Deployed a News Management System and a Media Asset Management system to support newsroom and media workflows.
- Implemented Proxmox VE virtualization.
- Deployed Active Directory infrastructure for the broadcast environment.
- Built Production Control Rooms (PCRs) for News14, Dharti TV, and City 21, delivering technical infrastructure for three broadcast operations.
- Deployed a Cisco ASA 5525-X (9.8) firewall and an OPNsense high-availability configuration running on Proxmox.
- Implemented VLAN-based network segmentation for each channel infrastructure.

SELECTED TECHNOLOGIES

Virtualization & storage: Proxmox VE, VMware ESXi/vSphere, Hyper-V, SAN/NAS/DAS, NetApp, QNAP, Promise, Sangfor HCI.

Identity & cloud: Windows Server, Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, Group Policy, Microsoft Azure, Entra ID, Intune, Microsoft 365, Exchange Online.

Networking & security: Cisco ASA 5525-X (9.8), OPNsense, Fortinet, Sangfor, VLANs, VPN, routing/switching, multi-link connectivity, Kaspersky, Microsoft Defender.

Resilience & broadcast: Veeam Backup & Replication v12, replication, disaster recovery, RTO/RPO, LTO archival, News Management Systems, Media Asset Management, PCR/MCR, Vizrt 2.6~ 3.8, Octopus V5~V8 NRCS.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE — CONTINUED

Manager, Cloud Operations & Support | Optimizers LAB

Oct 2022 - Sep 2026 |Islamabad - Karachi, Pakistan

Managed-services and consulting role with client assignments in Pakistan and Qatar.

- Supported production infrastructure for 1,500+ users across Windows/Linux servers, storage, Active Directory, and virtualized environments; reported approximately 99.9% production uptime.
- Designed and operated VMware and Hyper-V environments, including capacity planning, high availability, and performance baselines.
- Administered Exchange 2019, Exchange Online, Microsoft 365, and hybrid mail routing; supported SQL Server 2019 environments.
- Established Veeam backup, replication, retention, and recovery testing; administered Fortinet and OPNsense security policies and network segmentation.
- Mentored IT staff and standardized operational procedures and documentation across client sites.

Client Assignment: IT Operations Executive (ITSM L2) | Veroke

Feb 2026 - Sep 2026 | Islamabad, Pakistan

- Owned IT operations spanning connectivity, VPN, remote access, RDP/VDI, and infrastructure support for software engineering and DevOps teams.
- Maintained 99%+ Internet, intranet, and Wi-Fi availability through multi-link redundancy, route optimization, and ISP/vendor SLA coordination.
- Resolved infrastructure and connectivity issues affecting CI/CD workflows; tested remote-access environments ahead of production rollout.
- Administered Intune device enrollment, compliance, patching, and Defender security triage across Windows 11, macOS, and Ubuntu fleets; supported Microsoft Teams calling and call-quality troubleshooting.

Client Assignment: Veeam DR Architect | Qatar Primary Materials Company (QPMC)

2023 - 2025 | Qatar

- Architected and deployed Veeam Backup & Replication for 120 virtual and physical servers across production and disaster recovery sites.
- Protected Windows, Linux, and SAP/HANA workloads against defined recovery time and recovery point objectives (RTO/RPO).
- Implemented DR-site replication and LTO tape archival, with tested failover/failback and management reporting; delivered approximately 30% faster recovery.

Broadcast Engineer (Acting Manager IT) | JAAG Broadcasting / SAMAA TV

Jun 2021 - Oct 2022 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Managed Windows/UNIX broadcast infrastructure, Exchange Server 2016, Active Directory, and Fortinet/Sangfor firewalls for 24/7 live news operations.
- Implemented Kaspersky endpoint security and patching baselines; maintained editorial systems and PCR/MCR technology continuity.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Floor Manager, Media Operations | Pakistan Media City

Dec 2019 - Jun 2022 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Coordinated media operations, supported technology roll-outs, and delivered knowledge-sharing sessions for production and editing teams.

Senior System Administrator | Television Media Network / Express TV

Apr 2012 - Nov 2019 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Administered VMware ESX, QNAP/Promise storage, Vizrt graphics, and Octopus NRCS supporting newsroom and PCR/MCR operations.
- Led wireless and core network improvements and implemented operational security controls; maintained a seven-year record without major on-air IT failures.

Senior System Administrator | SevenIT

Jan 2011 - Mar 2012 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Managed Active Directory, network maintenance, and VoIP services supporting the GreenBiz.au call center.

Senior System Administrator | HBN Dawn News TV

Dec 2006 - Dec 2010 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Supervised cross-platform support; administered Windows identity/network services and MDaemon mail; designed Apple Xserve/XRAID video and data archival.

Senior System Administrator | Roshni TV

Dec 2005 - Dec 2006 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Supported Active Directory, video encoding, Octopus NRCS, Vizrt, and Apple editing environments.

Senior System Administrator | GEO TV

Aug 2002 - Dec 2005 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Supported Windows/macOS client-server infrastructure and broadcast content transport in a 24/7 newsroom; supervised technical support and staff training.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration, Information Technology | PIMSAT, Karachi | 2011

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | 2004

SELECTED CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Microsoft: Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP); MCITP: Server Administrator; Microsoft Specialist: Windows 7, Configuring.

Kaspersky: Industrial CyberSecurity Administration and Investigation; Next EDR Optimum; XDR Expert Administration | Jul 2026. Administration, EDR, and XDR credentials listed as valid through Jul 2028.

Infrastructure training: Veeam Data Platform v12 (Backup & Replication); Cisco CCNA Academy 4.0; NetApp SAN Administration on Data ONTAP 7.3; VMware Technical Sales Professional (VMTSP); Linux System Administration-1; Digital Forensics and Ethical Hacking.

Language qualification: DELF A1 (French).